

News App Research — Adoption Plan

News App Research → Adoption Plan

Cross-reference of ideas from news-app-research.html (April 2026 feature compendium) against the current **News Digest** application. Each idea is classified as:

-  **Already shipped** — exists in some form; note how
-  **Partial** — related capability exists, could be extended
-  **Adoptable** — not in the app, good fit, worth adding
-  **Skip** — out of scope for this app’s shape (desktop-first, single-user, editorial UI)

App context recap: React 19 + Express 5 + SQLite, single-user (no accounts), newspaper-editorial UI, RSS → LLM summary pipeline, MindGames cognitive-resilience dashboard already covering bias/fallacy/compare-coverage, widgets (jobs, movies, weather, crypto, HN, PBS), chat-with-summary, morning briefing, Telegram export.

01 · AI-Powered Core Features

Idea	Status	Notes
Multi-Source Story Clustering	 Adoptable	App summarizes per category but doesn’t cluster the same event across sources. High value — would dedupe the current feed noise. Could leverage embeddings + a daily sliding window (the academic K-means + BoW pattern from §08 of the report). Summaries already structured; consider tightening to a strict 3–5 bullet format at the top of each section for scannability.
AI Bullet-Point Summaries	 Already shipped	

Idea	Status	Notes
Conversational Follow-Up Chat 	Already shipped	"Ask about this news" exists. Worth surfacing the entry point at the bottom of every story section as Rize does, not only as a header button.
Guided Question Model	 Adoptable	After reading a summary, show 3 LLM-generated "angles you haven't considered." Natural fit next to existing chat — reuse the chat endpoint with a pre-seeded prompt. Complements the Scientist's Sandbox philosophy already in MindGames.
Story Timeline / Evolving Coverage	 Adoptable	Currently we have "Summary history by date" but not a per-story timeline that tracks an ongoing event across days. High value for elections/conflicts. Would require entity/event linking across summaries.
Sentiment Meter	 Partial	Per-section sentiment analysis exists. Surface it visually as a bar/dot next to each section header; include in morning briefing.
Global Perspectives View	 Adoptable	Not present. Would complement the existing Compare Coverage (Left/Center/Right) by adding a geographic axis (US / EU / non-Western). Could be a MindGames Analysis tab feature.
Morning AI Briefing	 Already shipped	Already exists; consider adopting the time-box + hard

Idea	Status	Notes
		cap idea (5–10 stories, auto-closes) as an explicit mode toggle.

02 · Bias & Transparency

Idea	Status	Notes
Bias Distribution Bar	● Partial	MindGames has a News Spectrum + Compare Coverage. A per-story inline bar on the homepage card (not only inside MindGames) would bring this to the main surface.
Blindspot Feed	● Adoptable	Not present. Would need cross-spectrum source ingestion and lopsided-coverage detection. Strong differentiator; aligns with the app's cognitive-resilience angle.
Source Credibility Score	● Adoptable	Per-publisher rating (static data from AllSides/MBFC/Ad Fontes). Show on each article card + allow filtering low-credibility sources out of the feed. Low effort, high trust payoff.
Ownership & Funding Transparency	● Adoptable	Static mapping of outlet → owner → known conflicts. Displayed on-hover over source name. Small dataset, one-time curation.
Full Coverage Side-by-Side	✓ Already shipped	Compare Coverage view in MindGames does this.
My News Bias Dashboard	● Adoptable	A personal analytics page showing which outlets/political

Idea	Status	Notes
		leans the user actually opens. Needs per-open event tracking — small schema addition to SQLite. Fits the “self-awareness” ethos of MindGames.

03 · Personalization & Curation

Idea	Status	Notes
Conversational Onboarding	 Skip	Single-user, config-driven app — onboarding flow is overkill. Per-section 👍 / 👎 would feed the LLM prompt for next generation (“avoid topics the reader downvoted”). Simple SQLite table + prompt injection.
Thumbs Up/Down Feedback Loop	 Adoptable	Morning briefing is finite; the homepage feed is not. Add a per-category “max N stories/day” setting that prunes AI output.
Capped Daily Story Counts	 Partial	
Hyper-Local Coverage	 Skip	Not aligned with the current editorial/global shape.
Preferred Sources Whitelist	 Partial	Feed management exists. Add a “boost this source” toggle that raises weight in morning briefing.
Paywall / Ad Filter	 Adoptable	Detect known-paywalled domains and either hide or tag them. Small curated list.
Scrap / Topic Collections	 Adoptable	“Save to collection” with named folders. Pairs well with existing summary history.

Idea	Status	Notes
Keyword Alert System	 Adoptable	User-defined keywords → Telegram push (Telegram integration already exists). Very low effort given the existing pipeline.

04 · Reading Experience

Idea	Status	Notes
Reader / Clean View Mode	 Partial	Summaries are already clean; for source articles , an extracted reader view (Jina / Readability) would replace the "open in new tab" jump.
Reading Time Estimate	 Adoptable	Trivial: <code>wordCount / 200 wpm</code> . Add to every summary section + morning briefing. Great expectation-setter.
Offline Mode / Download	 Partial	Summaries are cached server-side. A client-side PWA service-worker cache + "download today's digest" button would close the loop.
Cross-Device Reading Sync	 Skip	Single-user, self-hosted shape; sync is implicit via the server.
Swipe Card Interface	 Adoptable (optional)	Could be an alternative mobile layout — "Focus Mode" — one summary per screen with swipe. Paired with the capped-count idea, this becomes the app's anti-doomscroll mode.
Magazine-Style Layout	 Already shipped	5-column newspaper grid is already the editorial identity.
Data Visualisation Inline	 Partial	Recharts is in the stack (used in MindGames). Extend to inline charts in summaries when the

Idea	Status	Notes
Dark / Light Theme	 Already shipped	LLM detects numeric/time-series content. 4 newspaper themes.

05 · Audio & Multimedia

Idea	Status	Notes
TTS Article Narration	 Adoptable	Web Speech API is free and works in-browser — zero cost play button on each section. ElevenLabs upgrade path available. High demand per the report.
AI Audio Briefing / Podcast	 Adoptable	Render the morning briefing as a single TTS stream. With the existing chat endpoint, "PodTalk"-style interactive pause-and-ask is technically feasible.
Video News Tab	 Skip	Off-brand for an editorial text app.
Newsletter/Podcast Inbox	 Partial	RSS already ingests newsletters via feeds. A dedicated "Newsletters" category with a different render treatment could be a small addition.

06 · Gamification & Engagement

Idea	Status	Notes
Reading Streak	 Adoptable	Count consecutive days the user opens at least one summary. Flame icon in header. SQLite: single

Idea	Status	Notes
		user_activity(date) table. Proven 2.3x daily-engagement lift.
Milestone Badges	 Adoptable	"Read 100 summaries," "Explored 10 topics," "Completed 50 MindGames exercises." Complements the MindGames dashboard naturally.
Daily Current Events Quiz	 Already shipped	MindGames has a Daily Quiz. Consider auto-generating additional quiz items from today's summaries (not just MindGames techniques).
Polls & Prediction Games	 Adoptable (small)	Single-user so no "community" — but a private prediction log ("I think X will happen") with a look-back review is an interesting self-reflection tool.
Leaderboard	 Skip	Single-user app.
"Daily 5" Format	 Partial	Fits neatly alongside morning briefing — 5 quiz questions auto-generated from the day's summaries at 8 PM.

07 · Social & Community

Idea	Status	Notes
In-Article Discussions	 Skip	Single-user app.
Smart Share with Preview	 Adoptable	When exporting to Telegram, include bias-bar snapshot + source-count line. Telegram integration already exists — small prompt/template change.
Custom Magazines / Boards	 Partial	Same as Scrap Collections (§03).

Idea	Status	Notes
Opinion Spectrum View	✅ Already shipped	MindGames' Compare Coverage / News Spectrum covers this.

08 · Technical Patterns

Idea	Status	Notes
LLM Summarization Pipeline	✅ Already shipped	Current pipeline mirrors this. Missing piece: relevance scoring / noise reduction as a distinct step before summarization. Would improve the signal-to-noise ratio significantly.
Microservice Architecture	⬜ Skip	Monolithic Express is right-sized for a single-user self-hosted app.
Self-Hosted RSS Reader	✅ Already shipped	rss-parser + SQLite WAL ≈ newspipe's shape.
React Frontend Patterns	✅ Already shipped	React 19 + shadcn + Tailwind + Vite + TS — exact stack match.
AI Classification + Clustering (sliding window)	🟢 Adoptable	The 5-day sliding-window K-means approach is the right pattern for story clustering (§01) without re-embedding the entire corpus daily.

Priority Recommendation (for this app specifically)

Mapping the report's matrix to what's actually missing here:

Ship First (high value, low effort)

1. **Reading time estimate** — one wordCount/200 util, displayed everywhere
2. **Reading streak counter** — single table, header badge
3. **Keyword alerts to Telegram** — reuses existing Telegram pipeline

4. **Thumbs up/down feedback** — feeds next-day prompt
5. **TTS play button** — Web Speech API, zero cost
6. **Source credibility badge** — static data, per-outlet
7. **Paywall tagging** — curated domain list
8. **Inline bias bar on homepage cards** — MindGames data, just surface it

Plan for V2 (high value, higher effort)

1. **Multi-source story clustering** (sliding-window embeddings)
2. **Story timeline across days** for ongoing events
3. **Audio briefing** (TTS-rendered morning digest with queue)
4. **Guided question model** after each summary
5. **Ownership transparency hover cards**
6. **Blindspot feed** — needs cross-spectrum ingestion
7. **My News Bias dashboard** — event tracking + self-reflection view

Experiment With (differentiators)

1. **Focus Mode** — swipe-card single-story layout for mobile, auto-closes after N
2. **Daily 5** — 5 quiz questions generated from today's actual summaries (extends existing Daily Quiz)
3. **Global perspectives axis** in Compare Coverage (geographic, not just political)
4. **Private prediction log** with look-back review

Meta-principles worth stealing

From the report's closing callout: *"40% of people now actively avoid the news. The apps that win make staying informed feel manageable, trustworthy, and even fun."* This app already leans hard into **trust** (MindGames) and **editorial calm** (newspaper UI). The gaps to close are **habit mechanics** (streaks, quizzes, audio) and **story-level clustering** (kill duplicate-headline fatigue).